

The Year We Plan For

Samoa's rain, heat and the decisions between them.

This framework makes one limited point: resilience cannot be planned around an average year. It shows observed national rainfall variability alongside sea-surface-temperature context — without predicting local water security or claiming causation.

THE QUESTION

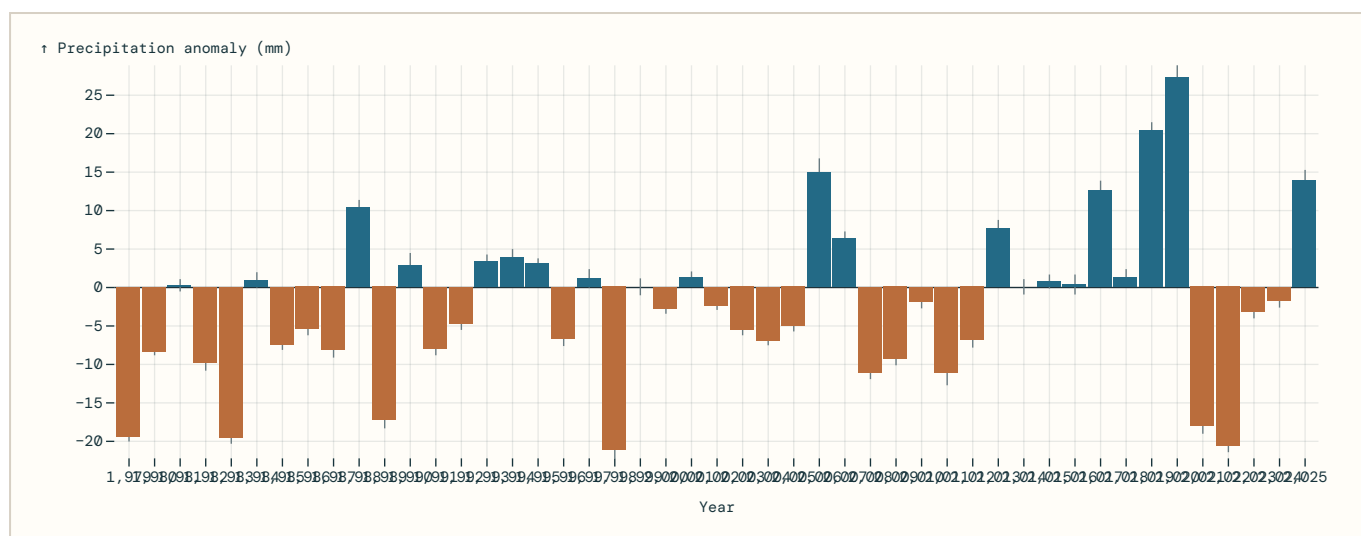
What changes when a climate plan is tested against the years Samoa has already experienced?

National data can show context and variability. It cannot decide what an individual village, catchment or household needs. Local evidence and consent remain an evidence gate.

01 • VARIABILITY

The average year is not the year people plan for.

Annual precipitation anomalies, relative to the official 1991–2020 reference period. Bars show measured anomaly; fine lines show reported standard error.

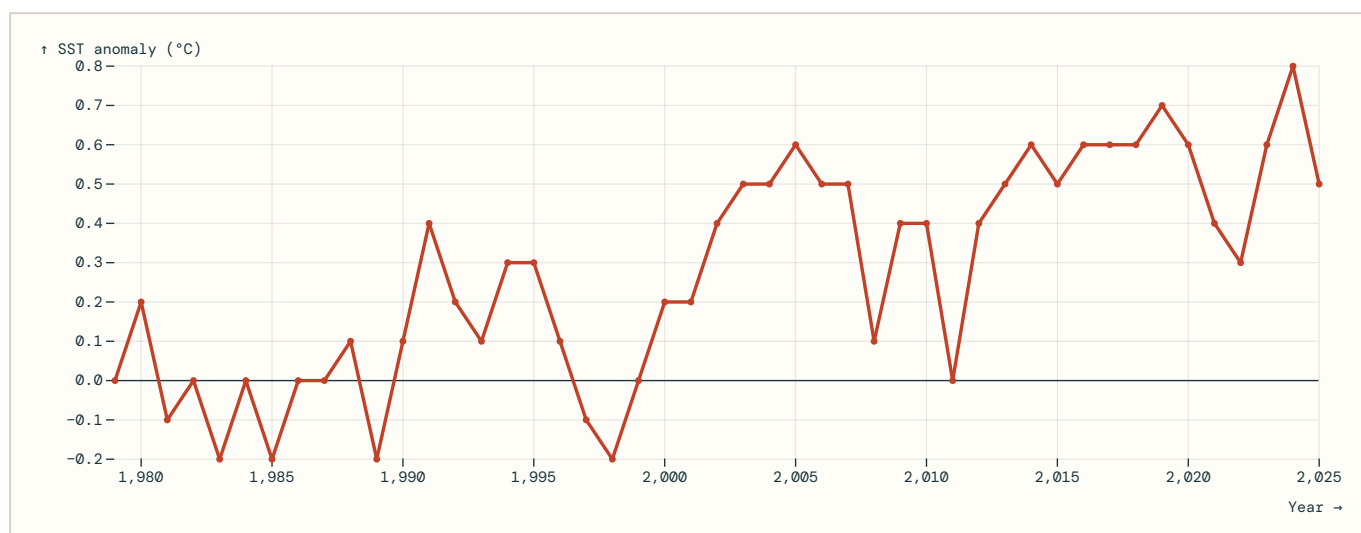


Observed annual national aggregate. A negative bar is below the reference average; it is not a local drought declaration.

02 • CONTEXT

The ocean backdrop is not static.

Annual Samoa EEZ sea-surface-temperature anomalies, relative to the official 1971–2000 reference period.



This is an EEZ aggregate, not a coastal or inshore temperature record. It is displayed alongside rainfall for context, not as proof of a causal relationship.

03 • BEFORE ANY FORECAST

Evidence gates for the next build

Seasonal preparedness

Add a below/near/above-normal outlook only when an authoritative product and its hindcast skill are documented.

Food resilience

Add a selected crop only after provenance and interpretation have been checked. Correlation must not become a causal claim.

Local decisions

Add station, catchment or community detail only with authorised data, quality metadata and, where relevant, local review.

What this draft does not do

- Forecast water-system failure, disaster impacts or crop yields.
- Rank villages or communities.
- Convert missing data into zeroes.
- Use a single number to define “resilience”.

Sources and limitations: [SPC rainfall SDMX](#) · [SPC SST SDMX](#) · [Challenge data catalogue](#).